Hunter questionnaire

Short answers are fine. Just tell it how it happened. A successful hunt, a missed chance, or a story that is still unfinished can all be worth telling.

Name you want used: _____

Best way to reach you: _____

1. How did you get into whitetail hunting, and who got you started?

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2. What hunt do you still find yourself talking about? What makes that one stick with you?

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3. What year or season was it, and what general area were you hunting? No exact spots needed.

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4. What led up to that hunt? Had you seen that deer before, or did it show up out of nowhere?

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5. Give me the short version of what happened, from getting there to how the hunt ended.

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6. Was there a moment where something went right, went wrong, or changed your plan?

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7. Who else was part of it, and do you have any photos, videos, messages, or other things from that hunt?

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8. Is there anything you would rather keep private, or anything I need to understand before we talk?

You can reply by text, voice message, or on this page. These answers help me prepare for our conversation. We will talk separately about recording and what you want shared publicly.

The hunter and the buildup

Confirm recording permission before starting. Let them tell the story in their own order, then use these questions to fill the gaps. Skip anything they have already answered.

Before the first question: Ask them to say their name and confirm its pronunciation. For answers used as voice-over, invite enough context to make sense without hearing your question. Keep their own wording.

Getting to know them

1. Tell me a little about yourself and where hunting fits into your life.

2. Who first took you hunting? What do you remember about being out there with them?

3. What keeps you going back now?

Choosing the story

4. What hunt are we talking about today, and why that one?

5. Before that day, what did you know about this deer or this place?

If it was a deer they knew: first sighting, trail-camera photos, earlier encounters, seasons spent watching it.

6. What had you put into getting ready for that hunt?

Scouting, time, practice, the setup, changes they made, and what was difficult.

Going back to that day

7. Start at the beginning of that day. What was going on before you got out there?

8. Walk me into your setup. What could you see and hear from where you were?

Ask about weather, terrain, the approach, equipment and who was there when they matter to the account.

9. What were you expecting to happen, and what actually happened before you saw the deer?

Notes and details to return to

The encounter and the outcome

Slow down when the deer appears. Get the sequence clearly before asking what it meant. Do not suggest what they must have felt or fill in details they cannot remember.

10. When did you first realize the deer was there? What caught your attention?

11. Where was it, what was it doing, and what happened next?

12. What options did you have at that point? What made you decide what to do?

If relevant: distance, visibility, shot angle, obstacles, waiting, or choosing not to shoot.

13. Take me through the next few seconds as closely as you remember them.

14. What could you actually see or hear afterward? What were you unsure about?

15. What did you do next, and who else became involved?

16. How did that hunt end? What do you know for sure, and what is still unanswered?

Follow the outcome they describe

If the deer was recovered

• Walk me through the recovery. What did you notice when you reached it?

• Who was the first person you called or told? What happened in that conversation?

If it was a miss or they passed on the shot

• What happened to the deer after that? Did you see it again?

• How do you understand that decision or miss now?

If there was a hit or possible hit and no recovery

• What did you observe, and what did the search involve?

• What was the last thing you could confirm? What never got resolved?

Keep observations separate from assumptions. Leave an uncertain ending uncertain. Get the factual account without making the hunter perform distress or asking for graphic details for a promotional clip.

What stayed with them

Let the meaning come from the hunter. A quiet answer can be enough. Do not push for a lesson, a dramatic ending, or a brand slogan.

17. What part of that hunt do you remember most clearly today?

18. What did that hunt mean to you at the time? Has that changed since then?

19. Did it change anything about how you hunt or how you see things?

20. Who else is part of this story in a way people might not realize?

21. What happened after that season, or what are you hoping happens next?

22. What have I not asked that belongs in this story?

Natural follow-ups when an answer needs more

- What happened next?
- When you say that, what do you mean?
- What do you remember seeing or hearing right then?
- What was going through your head?
- You mentioned that earlier. Can we go back to it?

Short pickups after the full story

Use only when they add something. These can provide an opening, a brief preview, or an ending without asking the hunter to turn the whole interview into sound bites.

- What is the moment in this story you would start with if you were telling a friend?
- What is the one detail someone would miss if they only saw the photo?
- Where does this story leave you now?

Strong moments and possible opening

Details to confirm

Keep this page with the interviewer. Confirm these details privately and record the agreed uses before filming or publishing. The short questionnaire does not provide publication permission.

Names and the facts

• Preferred public name, pronunciation, general hometown if wanted, and any requested credit or social handle.

• Hunt year or season, general area, timeline, participants, outcome, and any dates or details that remain uncertain.

• What must stay private: stand locations, landowners, exact coordinates, names, family details, or parts of the account.

Existing material and location coverage

• What photos, trail-camera images, video, messages, or keepsakes exist? Who made or owns each item, and can it be used?

• Which images were actually captured during this hunt? Which are from another day?

• Can we visit the relevant place with permission? What original gear or meaningful details could be filmed?

• Are they comfortable revisiting the location or demonstrating their preparation? Clearly identify recreated scenes when viewers could mistake them for original footage.

Recording and the feature

• Confirm interview recording permission and the places where filming is allowed.

• Agree separately on the full episode, website story, member page, still images, short social clips, and any promotional or paid advertising use.

• Confirm permission to introduce them as a member of The Whitetail Syndicate and use their agreed public name and images. Explain that this recognizes their featured story.

• Agree how they will review the factual details and their portrayal before anything is published. Record corrections and final approval.

> Do not ask for a scripted endorsement or assume that member recognition includes apparel endorsement, payment, benefits, or advertising permission. Record any separate arrangement explicitly.

Agreements and next step

Recording agreed: _____ **Member recognition agreed:** _____

Allowed uses and privacy limits: _____

Materials and permissions still needed: _____

Review contact and next step: _____